KEVIN AUYOUNG

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SENIOR NARRATIVE AND TECHNICAL GAME DESIGNER

Crafts emotionally engaging content and systems for AAA console and VR games, with 6 shipped titles including *Star Wars: The Force Unleashed* and *Mafia III* (15M+ combined players). Specializes in narrative and mission systems design, taking levels from blockout to final and building modular pipelines that let teams implement and iterate at scale. Most recently designed workflow improvements that cut team iteration time by more than half on an unannounced title with major IP. Bridges narrative, engineering, and art to take stories from prototype to launch at a high quality bar.

SKILLS

Narrative & Gameplay Systems Design | Mission Design | Player Agency & Readability | Gameplay Sequencing
Modular Content Pipelines| Data-Driven Design | Gameplay Scripting | Combat & Encounter Design
Encounter Pacing | Sandbox & Emergent Gameplay | Prototyping & Playtest Iteration
Cross-Discipline Collaboration | Unreal Engine (UE4/UE5) | Blueprints | Unity | C++ | C#

EXPERIENCE

SANZARU, AR/VR @ META, San Mateo, CA
Senior Designer IC6, August 2024 - March 2026
Unreleased: Unannounced title working with major IP

- Designed a modular narrative gameplay system built around content chunking, progression, and pacing, cutting iteration time by more than half and reducing build instability.
- Spearheaded team-wide adoption of the new system, trained all 15 designers, and wrote documentation and reference materials so the team could use and maintain tools on their own.
- Partnered with engineering from early pre-production to co-develop narrative system architecture, implementation tooling, and data-driven debugging workflows that reduced implementation brittleness and established scalable pipelines for the full design team.
- Pitched, prototyped in Figma and UE5, and drove implementation of core content systems across design and engineering - taking early pre-production problems from whiteboard to shippable tools.
- Worked directly with level and narrative designers to integrate content into narrative systems, defining gameplay states, and refining sequencing logic to improve player flow and reduce implementation errors.
- Mentored 2-3 designers and narrative partners on system workflows and tooling, helping maintain consistency and raising the team's technical proficiency with narrative implementation workflows.

Senior Designer IC5, August 2018 - August 2024
Shipped: Asgard's Wrath 2, Asgard's Wrath, Spyro Reignited.

- Delivered 60+ hours of main and side story implementation on Asgard's Wrath 2 and integrated gameplay systems, resolving cross-team technical issues, and ensuring content shipped at quality.
- Mentored a junior and mid-level designer on tools and workflow, allowing them to independently complete and ship six quests during a key production phase.
- Owned two levels end-to-end on Asgard's Wrath 1 & 2, from blockout through narrative scripting, dialogue integration, final gameplay pacing and polish, and level profiling and optimization to hit performance targets.
- Pitched and contributed to core game systems including the creature hunting system and codex, helping shape player-facing features beyond assigned content responsibilities.
- Recreated the four Sparx levels from the original Spyro games for the rerelease in partnership with one engineer, balancing fidelity to the source material with technical constraints of the new platform.

HANGAR 13, Novato, CA **June 2013 - July 2017**

Senior Mission Designer

Shipped: Mafia 3 and DLC.

- Designed and implemented 3 areas from blockout to final on Mafia 3 and Stones Unturned DLC using Illusion Engine, owning full mission lifecycle from concept through gameplay scripting, narrative pacing, and replayability.
- Scripted mission gameplay, narrative moments, and story pacing while debugging flow and implementation throughout production.
- Prototyped NPC stealth-follow gameplay mechanics to evaluate player engagement and guidance; findings informed the decision to cut the mechanic before full production investment.
- Worked with world design to place open world activities and adapt the environment around main missions, ensuring content felt grounded in the world rather than layered on top of it.

KABAM, San Francisco, CA **January 2012 - May 2013**

Designer

- Developed a level editor in Maya using MEL and Python to quickly generate content for an online strategy game.
- Built gameplay prototypes and UI layouts in Unity with C# for an early action RPG project, contributing to gameplay iteration and implementation workflows.

FEARLESS STUDIOS, San Francisco, CA **January 2011 - December 2011**

Designer

Unreleased: FPS and MOBA prototypes

- Collaborated on the concept and pitch of an unreleased FPS game, contributing across UI, character setup, and gameplay prototyping.
- Took part in team multiplayer testing and debugging of an unreleased MOBA concept
- Built game prototypes in Unreal Engine 3 using UnrealScript and C++.

LUCASARTS, San Francisco, CA **January 2007 - November 2010**

Level Designer

Shipped: Star Wars: The Force Unleashed, Star Wars: The Force Unleashed DLC, Star Wars: The Force Unleashed 2.

- Designed and shipped 2-3 areas from blockout to final across Star Wars: The Force Unleashed and TFU2, with additional mission development on DLC - contributing to a title that won the Writers Guild Award for Video Game Writing.
- Implemented gameplay scripting including targeted Force power interactions, destruction sequences, and set-piece moments in LucasFilm's proprietary engine while serving as a technical resource for mission scripting across the team.

EDUCATION

Master of Entertainment Technology
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh PA

Bachelor of Science
Electrical and Computer Engineering
Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh PA